

# A benefits check that tells no one it was asked

A one-page note for benefits advisers — Carers UK, Citizens Advice, Age UK, and anyone who helps people claim.

## What it is

**Owed** is a free, open benefits check for pension-age support and Carer's Allowance that runs entirely on the client's own device. No account, no server, no analytics: the page makes **no network request at all** — open your browser's network panel and watch. Saved to a memory stick, it works with the internet off. When the tab closes, it forgets everything.

That matters for the people advisers see most: the carer afraid that asking a question starts an investigation, the pensioner who will not put her savings into a government form. Owed lets them look first, privately — and change one answer to watch the amounts move ("what if I claimed Attendance Allowance?") before deciding anything.

**What it covers** — deliberately small: Attendance Allowance · Carer's Allowance · Pension Credit (guarantee) · Housing Benefit (pension age) · Council Tax Reduction (pension age, England) · Winter Fuel Payment · free TV licence over 75 · Pension Age Disability Payment (Scotland) — plus the statutory pensionable-age table. Rates are pinned to a named tax year; when that year passes, the page says so loudly rather than going quietly wrong.

## Why you can check it instead of trusting it

- Every question names the rule that lets it ask, and every amount shows its working, linked to legislation.gov.uk and gov.uk. A question with no cited rule cannot exist: the form is generated from the rules.
- The rules are small public data files anyone can read. An independent judge — a separate program — recomputes every test case from the same files on every change; the page is one client of those rules, never the door.
- The client can download their answers as a small file they keep. Nothing exists unless they choose to save it; they can bring the file to an appointment and drop it back in. Data minimisation by construction, not policy.

## Where it stops

- It prompts a claim; it never makes one, and it is not advice. Your judgement stays the point of the appointment.
- Eight entitlements, pension-age weighted. No Universal Credit, no PIP, no working-age support. A full calculator still covers far more — this is the private first look, not a replacement for it.
- Coverage is uneven across the UK: Scottish and Northern Irish equivalents are named where rules differ, but only Pension Age Disability Payment is encoded so far.

**Why a carers' charity specifically.** Behind this tool sits a corpus of fifty-two encoded institutional failures — one of them the Carer's Allowance overpayment scandal, worked through step by step: the state watched the earnings data as the debt grew, then prosecuted the growth. Owed is the other half of that finding — the earnings limit checked privately, before the first pound of overpayment, by the person it protects.

## The ask

Run your hardest real cases against it, anonymised, next to the calculator you already use. Where it disagrees, misses, or asks a question badly, the rules are public and fixable — say so in the open, or reply to the sender. A tool for advisers should be corrected by advisers.

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Part of the Civic Kernel prototype — an open, non-commercial design study. The tool: [glassontin.github.io/civic-kernel/owed.html](https://glassontin.github.io/civic-kernel/owed.html). This note prints to one side of A4.

[Sender: add your name and contact line here before printing or attaching.]